7 Indian National Movement – Phase I (1905-1917)

Partition of Bengal (1905) and Reactionary Policies of Curzon (1899 – 1905)

Lord Curzon assumed office as Viceroy of India on December 30, 1898. In July 1905, a Royal Proclamation announced the partition of Bengal, leading to the creation of a new province—Eastern Bengal and Assam—by reducing the size of the erstwhile Bengal Presidency. This newly formed province later evolved into East Pakistan and, eventually, present-day Bangladesh.

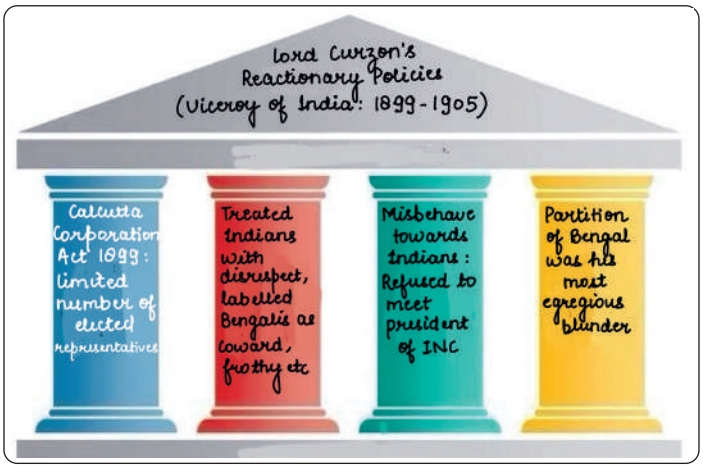

Fig. 7.1: Reactionary Policies of Lord Curzon
Diagram Type: *Pillar*

Curzon's Regressive Policies & Their Effects (UPSC 2019)

- **Pave way for political instability:** Curzon's impolitic statements and imperialist intentions exacerbated India's political instability. Curzon's imperialistic actions sparked a backlash, stinging Indian politics.
- **Birth to a sense of nationhood:** His tyranny gave birth to a deeper sense of nationhood. In this light, Curzon proved to be an unintentional benefactor of India.
- **Swadeshi movement:** The Swadeshi movement was founded in Bengal in 1905, with a demand to boycott British products in favour of Swadeshi. It was most likely the first big movement following the 1857 rebellion.
- **Anti-colonial movement:** The anti-colonial movement was first led by moderates, but it was later overtaken by extremists and extended to embrace the entire country. Tilak, Bipin Pal, and Aurobindo Ghose were beginning to control the Congress.
- **The emergence of revolutionary activities:** Later, revolutionary organisations such as Jugantar began to emerge. They took an active role in anti-colonial campaigns and attempted to instill nationalism in young people.

Lord Curzon's Reforms

- **Universities Commission in 1902:** He established Universities Commission in 1902 to look into the entire issue of university education in the country.
- **Indian Universities Act of 1904:** He Curzon enacted the Indian Universities Act of 1904 in response to the Commission's findings and recommendations, bringing all universities in India under government authority.
- **Scientific reforms:** The Agriculture Research Institute was Established on 26 December 1903 in Pusa (Bihar - Bengal Presidency).
- **Administrative:** He worked to reform the police, eliminate corruption, and promote economic development.
  - **Revitalized conservatism**: He revitalized conservatism in India by updating the main features of Lord Mayo's policies.
  - **Police Reform:** In 1902, he established the Police Commission, which was chaired by Sir Andrew Frazer. Curzon accepted and implemented all of the recommendations.
  - **Established training schools:** He established training schools for both officers and constables and established provincial police services.
  - **NWFP established:** The Northwest Frontier Province (NWFP) was establish in November 1901 during the Curzon regime, and it covered roughly the upper course of the River Indus.
- **Imperial Cadet Corps was established:** The Imperial Cadet Corps was established, which later served as a tool for Indianizing the army.

Background and Government Motive for Partition

- **Official reasons:** Bengal was a **single large province** that included the states of Bihar, Orissa, Bengal, and Dacca. Partition considers separating the Muslim population into East Bengal and Bihar, as well as Orissa and a portion of Bengal as another province.
- **Administrative ease:** The government said that it was done to foster growth in Bengal's underdeveloped eastern part and for administrative ease because Bengal was the largest province in terms of population, making administration challenging.
- **Real motive Divide and Rule:** However, the major goal was to 'Divide and Rule' the most advanced section of the country at the time, and the Muslim community was drawn away by the promise of a separate province for them.
- **Attack on Bengali culture and language:** Nationalists saw it as a challenge to Indian nationalism, not just a bureaucratic measure. They considered it as an attack on the face of Bengali culture and language.
- **To break the nerve of the nationalist movement:** In the words of Curzon, it aimed "to dethrone Calcutta," as it was the nerve centre of Congress at the time and a key centre of the nationalist movement.
- **Schism within Congress:** The Partition also caused a schism within the Congress, as moderates sought to limit the partition campaign to Bengal alone.
- **Nationwide agitation:** Extremists, on the other side, sought to initiate a nationwide agitation and make their influence felt by establishing a Swadeshi Movement.

Nationalist Response to Partition

- **Rising tensions:** This heightened tensions between the two sides, which came to an end in the 1906 session of Congress when a face-off was averted by choosing Dadabhai Naroji as president (he was regarded by both factions and as a result, Tilak - the hardline leader - also consented to his name). However, he was at once the favourite for the presidency).

Swadeshi Movement (1905)

On **August 7, 1905**, a boycott resolution passed in the **Calcutta Town Hall assembly**, and the Swadeshi movement was officially launched.

B. G. Tilak

Swaraj or self-government is essential for the exercise of swadharma. Without Swaraj, there could be no social reform, no industrial progress, no useful education, and no fulfilment of national life. That is what we seek, that is why God has sent us to the world to fulfill Him.

Background and Actions Carried out Throughout the Movement

- **Anti-partition campaign:** The Swadeshi movement began as a protest against the British decision to partition Bengal.
- **Swadeshi Movement:** Marked a major phase in the Indian National Movement at the turn of the 20th century.
- **Day of Sorrow:** October 16, 1905—the day of Bengal's partition—was observed with mourning.
- **Hindu-Muslim Unity:** People tied *rakhis* to symbolize communal harmony and Bengal's unity; ritual baths were taken in sacred rivers.
- **National Anthem and Song:** *Bande Mataram* was widely sung and nearly became the national anthem; Tagore composed *Amar Sonar Bangla*, which later became Bangladesh's national anthem in 1971.
- **Tricolour Flag:** A flag with red, green, and yellow was designed, featuring eight lotuses for the eight provinces and a crescent symbolizing Hindu-Muslim unity.
- **Reviving Ancient Glory:** The past was revisited to highlight India's achievements in art, architecture, science, math, religion, law, and trade. Subhramania Bharti wrote sudesha Geetham, Abhinendra Nath Tagore broke domination of Victorian naturalism over Indian art
- **Import Ban:** The movement led to a decline in foreign textile demand; boycotts targeted Manchester cloth and Liverpool salt.
- **Corps of Volunteers:** Extremists formed volunteer groups or *Samitis* to spread political awareness; for example, Ashwini Kumar Dutt's *Swadeshi Bandhab Samiti* in Bengal.

Fact-Wise

- **Fall in the quantity of imported cotton piece goods:** Between August 1905 and September 1906, there was a 22 per cent fall in the quantity of imported cotton piece goods, 44 per cent in cotton twist and yarn, 11 per cent in salt, 55 per cent in cigarettes and 68 per cent in boots and shoes.
- **More than nativistic upsurge:** The Boycott movement, therefore, was much more than a 'nativistic upsurge' that rejected European products.

The Movement's Leadership

- **Leadership:** The moderates, particularly Surendernath Banarjee, Krishan Kumar Mitra, and P C Ray, provided the initial leadership. During the movement, both moderates and extremists worked together.
- **In Punjab:** In Punjab, the movement was led by Ajit Singh and Lajpat Rai.
- **In Delhi:** In Delhi, Syed Haider Raza assumed authority.
- **In Madras:** Chidambaram Pillai led the movement to the Madras Presidency, which was further energized by Bipin Chandra Pal's long lecture tour.
- **In Bombay presidency:** G. K. Gokhale and B. G. Tilak led the movement.

Swadeshi Movement & Divided Congress

- **Resolutions in Calcutta session:** Before the partition, four resolutions were voted on in the Calcutta session under Dada Bhai Naoroji - Boycott, National Education, Swadeshi, and Condemnation of Partition.
- **Contention over resolution:** The issue of whether these resolutions should be retained or rejected became a major source of contention in Congress.
- **Moderates want to limit scope:** A faction led by moderates sought to limit the movement's scope.
- **Pan-India movement:** Extremists wanted to make it a pan-Indian movement in the form of a broad fight.
- **Beyond partition politics & Swaraj:** Furthermore, extremists wanted to go beyond partition politics and seek full Swaraj, whilst moderates believed that the country was not yet ready for such demands and mass mobilisation.

Impact of Swadeshi Movement

Reasons for the Decline

- **Surat split:** There was dissent in Congress, and its break in 1907 (Surat break) weakened leadership.
- **Government repression:** In 1908, Tilak was imprisoned for six years and Ashwini Kumar Dutt and others were exiled.
- **Vacuum of leadership:** Bipin Chandra Pal and Aurobindo Ghosh both stepped out from politics.
- **Lack of inertia:** The movement was hampered by a lack of inertia.
- **Economic ramifications of boycott:** Due to limited domestic supply and economic ramifications, ordinary people could no longer continue to boycott imported goods. Another concern was job loss.

Fig. 7.2: Swadeshi Movement
Diagram Type: *Hub & Spoke*

- **Harsh reaction of government:** The government reacted harshly, and students were expelled, others were fired, and arrests were made.

Assessment of Swadeshi Movement

Significance of the Swadeshi Movement

- **Widespread engagement:** The Swadeshi and boycott campaigns were India's first twentieth-century movements that encouraged widespread engagement in modern nationalist politics.
- **Women participation:** For the first time, women walked out of their homes to join processions and picket lines against stores selling foreign-made items.
- **Shifted the nature of INC:** The Swadeshi and boycott movements also shifted the nature of the Indian National Congress (INC) from being mostly driven by moderates to the major agenda now being defined by the extremists who gave the Congress's 1906 Calcutta session call for swaraj or self-government.
- **Ideals of passive resistance emerged:** The ideals of non-cooperation and passive resistance, which Mahatma Gandhi effectively used many years later, originated in the beginning of twentieth century Swadeshi and boycott movements.

Criticism of the Swadeshi Movement

- **Lack of all India participation:** Southern states were mostly unaffected by the movement.
- **Peasant class unaffected:** It could not also carry it along with the peasant class and is thus frequently criticized as a middle-class movement.
- **Lack of Muslim participation:** The majority of Muslims did not participate, or their involvement was limited. In the end, the Muslim League was founded in 1906.
- **Communal angle:** When Hindus idealized the past when the images honoured were derived from Hindu imagery, members from other communities felt excluded.

Muslim League (1906)

The All-India Muslim League (also known as the Muslim League) was a **political party founded in British India in 1906**. It was founded as a political alternative to the Indian National Congress to serve the interests of Indian Muslims.

Foundation

- **Formed in Lucknow:** By 1901, establishing a national Muslim political party was regarded as critical. The initial step of its establishment was a conference in Lucknow in September 1906, attended by representatives from all around India.
- **Simla deputation:** In October 1906, the Simla Deputation reassessed the problem and resolved to establish the party's aims on the occasion of the Educational Conference's annual conference, which was to be held in Dhaka.
- **Renaming:** Meanwhile, Nawab Salimullah Khan produced a comprehensive proposal in which he proposed naming the party the All-India Muslim Confederacy.

Early Years

- **Foundation:** Sultan Muhammad Shah (Aga Khan III) was named the Muslim League's first honorary president, though he did not attend the first session in Dhaka.
- **Jinnah joined:** Mohammed Ali Jinnah joined the Muslim League in 1913.
- **Initial aim:** The League was founded to train students for service in the British Raj, but it quickly grew into a political force.

Participation in Nationalist Movement

- **Concerned by majority rule:** The Muslim League had always advocated for unity in an independent India, but they were concerned that it would be ruled by Hindus, who made up the majority of the population.
- **Allied with Congress:** Following World War I (1914-18), the Muslim League allied up with Congress to campaign for Home Rule inside the British Empire.
- **Jinnah's 14 points:** Furthermore, in the late 1920s and early 1930s, Jinnah compressed the ideas of Indian Muslims into 14 principles. These included ideas for a federal government and one-third of Muslim participation in the central government.
- **Supports war involvement:** Congress declined to approve this proclamation. While the Muslim League remained critical of British rule, they decided to support India's involvement in the war to establish a better negotiating position for independence.
- **Proponent of two-nation theory:** In what became known as the "two-nation theory," Jinnah began to advocate the establishment of a distinct Muslim state from lands that were then part of British India in 1940.

The Muslim League's goals were met four decades after its founding in Dhaka in 1906. The organization's political leaders proposed a separate country to safeguard Muslim commercial interests. Furthermore, the concept of a distinct Pakistan state began to gain traction among Indian Muslims.

Surat Split (1907) and its Impact

With the selection of Dadabhai Naoroji as the new president in 1906, an impending clash was avoided; both sides were pacified because he was admired by both. Naoroji presented the concept of 'Swaraj' at this session to reconcile disagreements, and it was declared as the aim of Congress.

B.G. Tilak: *The Extremists of today will be the Moderates of tomorrow, just as the Moderates of today were the Extremists of yesterday.*

Moderates	Extremists
Social base: Zamindars and upper middle classes in towns.	**Social base**: Educated middle and lower middle classes in towns.
Ideological inspiration: Western liberal thought and European history.	**Ideological inspiration**: Indian history, cultural heritage and Hindu traditional symbols.
Believed political connections: With Britain to be in India's social, political and cultural interests.	**Believed that political connections**: With Britain would perpetuate British exploitation of India.
Loyal: Professed loyalty to the British Crown.	**Unworthy British Crown**: Believed that the British Crown was unworthy of claiming Indian loyalty.
Masses not ready: Believed that the movement should be limited to middle-class intelligentsia; masses not yet ready for participation in political work.	**Faith in masses:** Had immense faith in the capacity of the masses to participate and to make sacrifices.
Constitutional demands: Demanded constitutional reforms and share for Indians in services.	**Swaraj**: Demanded Swaraj as the panacea for Indian ills.
Constitutional means: Insisted on the use of constitutional methods only.	**Extra constitutional means**: Did not hesitate to use extra-constitutional methods like boycotts and passive resistance to achieve their objectives.
Not a comprador: They were patriots and did not play the role of a comprador class.	**Made sacrifices**: They were patriots who made sacrifices for the country.

Causes of Split

- **Disagreement:** The disagreement arose over the continuation of four resolutions and the extension of the movement to the rest of the country.
- **Failure of Moderates:** When moderates failed to make significant inroads, extremists got agitated.
- **International influences:** Extremists were also inspired by two occurrences outside India, namely the defeat of Russia by Japan and the defeat of the Italian Army by Ethiopians, both of which shattered the image of European might.
- **Inaction of Morley:** Extremists were optimistic about the nomination of a new Secretary of State, Morley, but he did nothing about the partition question, which angered the Extremists.
- **Contention over presidentship:** Extremists wanted Tilak or Lala Lajpat Rai as president, but moderates wanted Rash Behari Bose to be president in the 1907 session.

The Impact

- **Divided into two parties:** The Indian National Congress (INC) split in 1907 in Surat resulted in the party being divided into two parties, the Extremists and the Moderates.
- **Weakened Congress:** This schism weakened Congress and hampered its ability to fight for Indian independence.
- **Prominence of extremists:** With extremists gaining prominence and eventually driving Congress towards a more militant and extreme approach to winning independence.
- **Shift in government attitude:** It also indicated a shift in the government's attitude and policy towards moderate nationalists.
- **Impetus for reforms:** The Surat Split was the impetus for the 1909 Minto-Morley Reform.

The Surat Split divided the Indian National Congress into **Moderates and Extremists**, weakening the freedom struggle. **Extremists** rose to prominence, steering Congress towards a more assertive stance. The division reflected a shift in **British policy** and influenced the **Minto-Morley Reforms (1909)**. Regarded as a **national setback**, the split temporarily stalled the movement. Yet, **Extremist revolutionary actions** revived public spirit against British rule. After **eight years**, both factions reunited at the **Lucknow Session (1916)**, restoring unity and momentum to the national movement.

Rise of Militant and Revolutionary Nationalism

The causes of the growth of extremists or militant nationalism are remarkably similar to the causes of the rise of nationalism in India. Leaders such as Tilak, Ashwini Kumar Dutt, and others have been involved in spreading militant nationalism since its inception. The Swadeshi Movement's leadership shifted from moderates to extremists like Bipin Chandra Pal, Aurobindo Ghosh, Tilak, and others.

Karachi Chronicle: *What one Asiatic has done, others can do... if Japan can drub Russia, India can drub England with equal ease... let us drive the British into the sea and take our place side by side with Japan among the great powers of the world.*

Reasons Behind Emergence

- **Failure of Moderates**: Politically aware Indians grew disillusioned with the Moderates as their peaceful pleas failed to alter British policies. Their belief that foreign rule could be reformed proved ineffective.
- **Curzon's Anti-Congress Approach**: Lord Curzon's hostile attitude towards the Congress led many to view it as ineffective and irrelevant.
- **Elite Nature of Congress**: Congress appeared elitist, resembling a Zamindari body dominated by upper-middle-class interests. Bankim Chandra likened its sessions to a mere "three-day annual show."
- **Ineffectiveness of ICA, 1892**: The Indian Councils Act of 1892 failed to meet expectations, undermining faith in Moderate strategies.
- **Global Inspiration**: Japan's victory over Russia and Ethiopia's defeat of Italy shattered the myth of Western racial superiority.
- **Harsh Repression**: Nationalist leaders like Lala Lajpat Rai and Ajit Singh were deported in 1907; K.K. Mitra and Ashwini Kumar Dutt followed in 1908. Tilak was jailed for six years the same year.
- **Rising Political Awareness**: Growing knowledge of political affairs led Indians to reject British rule and the idea of the "White Man's Burden."

Immediate Causes

- **Partition of Bengal:** During Curzon's reign, the partition of Bengal occurred, and it became one of the most important rallying moments in the history of the Indian liberation fight.
- **Other events:** like the Municipal Act and the Delhi Durbar in December 12, 1911, fuelled public outrage.
- **Failure of early militant nationalists:** They failed to give the movement a clear direction. They also failed to reach the general public.

Impacts of Revolutionary Movement

- **Political Awareness:** Acts like the assassination of British officials and the bombing campaigns by groups like the Anushilan Samiti in Bengal raised awareness and support for the independence movement among Indians.
- **British Repression:** In response to these violent acts, the British government enacted harsh laws, such as the Rowlatt Act of 1919, which allowed detention without trial, leading to widespread unrest and incidents like the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.
- **Influence on Nationalist Movements:** The radical methods of revolutionaries created a divide within the Indian nationalist movement, contrasting with leaders like Gandhi who advocated non-violence. However, the bravery of these revolutionaries also inspired many, particularly the youth.
- **Security Measures:** The British expanded their intelligence and policing efforts in India, establishing and enhancing agencies to counter revolutionary activities, a legacy that influenced India's own security apparatus post-independence.
- **Inspiration for Future Movements:** The sacrifices of early 20th-century revolutionaries inspired subsequent generations, including leaders like Subhas Chandra Bose and later nationalist movements, underscoring their enduring legacy in the fight against colonial rule.

Comparison between Revolutionary and Extremist

Aspect	Revolutionary	Extremist
Approach	Violent resistance and radical methods	Non-violent protests, petitions, and discussions
Goal	Complete independence from British rule	Greater autonomy within the British Empire initially
Key Figures	Bhagat Singh, Chandrashekhar Azad, Subhas Chandra Bose	Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Lala Lajpat Rai, Bipin Chandra Pal
Key Incidents	Kakori Consipiracy in 1925, Chittagong armoury raid in 1930	Partition of Bengal protests, Swadeshi Movement
Philosophy	Immediate overthrow of British rule, inspired by global revolutionary movements	Gradual increase in self-governance, influenced by moderate reforms and constitutional means
Impact on Freedom Struggle	Created urgency and international attention, inspired future generations	Laid foundation for wider participation in freedom movement, influenced later policies like the Non-Cooperation Movement

The Decline of the Revolutionary Movement

- **No mass support:** It was unable to mobilize the people. It had no support among the general public. They believed in personal heroics.
- **Unable to attain the goal:** This movement was unable to attain its goal of independence.
- **Leadership vacuum:** The assassination of Chandrasekhar Azad in a shooting encounter in a public park in Allahabad in February 1931 effectively ended the revolutionary struggle in Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, and Bihar. The martyrdom of Surya Sen also signified the end of terrorist activity in Bengal.
- **Rethinking of means:** The revolutionaries imprisoned in jails and in Andaman began a process of rethinking.
- **New ideologies:** Marxism was adopted by a huge number of revolutionaries.

Significance of the Revolutionary Movement:

- **Organised form:** Revolutionary movements began to take on an organised form under the influence of an organised national movement.
- **Encouraged Indians:** It encouraged Indians to violently overthrow British control in India.

Although they did not achieve their stated goal of achieving independence by armed revolution, they were successful in rallying people, self-governance, reading of authority from their minds, and striking horror into the hearts of the authorities.

Morley-Minto Reforms (1909) and Responses

Morley-Minto Reforms were carried out in 1909, while Lord Minto was Governor General of India.

Lord Morley: *Reforms may not save the Raj, but if they don't, nothing else will.*

Historical Background

- **Demand of Muslim leaders:** In October 1906, the Simla Deputation, led by the Agha Khan, met Lord Minto and demanded separate electorates for Muslims as well as representation greater than their numerical strength due to the "value of the contribution" Muslims were making "to the defence of the empire."
- **Muslim League:** The same group swiftly took over the Muslim League, which was founded in December 1906 by Nawab Salimullah of Dacca, Nawabs Mohsin-ul-Mulk, and Waqar-ul-Mulk.
- **Imperial allegiance:** The Muslim League attempted to promote imperial allegiance while keeping the Muslim elite away from the Congress.
- **Cracking down is not sufficient:** The Conservative Viceroy of India, Minto, and John Morley, the Liberal Secretary of State for India, both agreed that cracking down on uprisings in Bengal was important but not sufficient for restoring security to the British Raj following Lord Curzon's splitting of Bengal.
- **Instil hope:** They believed that a drastic step was required to instil hope in the Indian upper classes and the growing Westernized part of the population.

Positive Features

- **Element of self-government:** It included an element of self-government by allowing for indirect elections.
- **Budget voting:** included the ability to vote on a portion of the budget.
- **Authority to question:** More authority was granted in terms of questioning.
- **Representation:** There was more representation.

Negatives Features

- **Separate Electorates:** The reforms included, among other things, a separate electorate for Muslims.
- **Fostered communalism:** It planted the seeds of communalism and hindered India's historical progress toward unity. Lord Minto was dubbed the "Father of the Communal Electorate."
- **Diversion from plight:** It also diverted Indians' attention away from economic and political issues.
- **No real power:** extended Legislative Councils, but members were still chosen indirectly and the councils didn't have any actual powers, such as budget debate, though they were now permitted to pass resolutions, etc.
- **Limited Association of Indians:** With the Executive Council of the Viceroy and Governors. Satyendra Prasad Sinha (SP Sinha) was the first Indian to be appointed as a legal member of the Viceroy's Executive Council. (The number was limited to one).
- **Limited franchise:** The franchise was introduced for the first time - it was restricted, however, because women did not have voting rights, and it was also constrained in other ways.

The reforms of 1909 provided the country's citizens with a shadow rather than substance. The people desired self-government, but all they got was "**benevolent despotism**."

First World War (1914-1919), its Impact and Responses

In World War I (1914-1919), Britain joined with France, Russia, the United States, Italy, and Japan against Germany, Austria-Hungary, and Turkey.

Responses to World War I	
Extremists	**Support the misguided notion:** Tilak, **For example,** backed the war effort in the misguided notion that Britain would reward India's allegiance with gratitude in the form of self-government.
Moderates	**Support & expecting reciprocity:** Moderates, on the other hand, expressed their support for the government, expecting that it would reciprocate by easing off on them.
Revolutionaries	**Opportunity to wage war:** The revolutionaries were determined to take advantage of the opportunity to wage war against British rule and liberate the country.

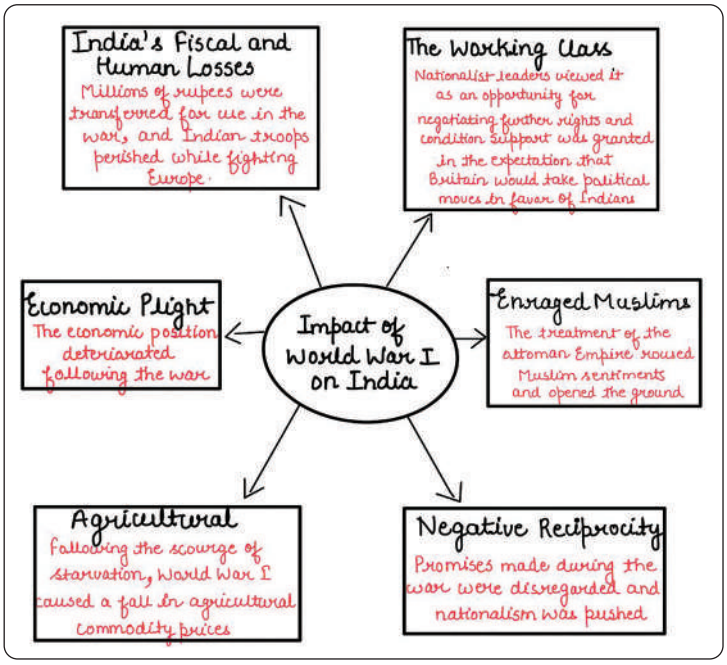

Fig. 7.3: Impact of World War I on India
Diagram Type: *Hub & Spoke*

Impact of the First World War on the Indian National Movement

Ghadar Party (1913) and Komagata Maru Incident (1914)

First World War and Ghadar Movement

- **Opportunity:** The world war also provided a chance for the Ghadarites to exploit the British overlords.
- **Using immigrants:** The Ghadarite leaders pushed immigrants on the western coast of the United States to return to India and launch an armed revolution with the help of the army. Some leaders were transferred to Far Eastern countries to persuade Indians to return.
- **Attempts to convert the army's devotion:** The ghadarites discovered the Punjab state to be significantly different. Nobody backed them up, and the khalsa even labelled them as **"fallen Sikhs."** Without strong leadership, their naive attempts to convert the army's devotion failed.
- **Turned to revolution:** They eventually turned to revolutionary leaders for guidance, but the government had successfully infiltrated the Ghadar. And, prior to the revolution, the majority of them were arrested. The government's reaction was harsh, and an entire generation of political leaders was eliminated.

The Komagata Maru Incident

- **Spark:** The significance of this incident stems from the fact that it sparked an explosive scenario in Punjab.
- **Singapore to Vancouver:** The Komagata Maru was the name of a ship bringing 370 people from Singapore to Vancouver, mostly Sikh and Punjabi Muslim would-be immigrants. After two months of hardship and uncertainty, they were sent back by Canadian authorities.
- **British influence:** It was widely assumed that the Canadian authorities were swayed by the British administration. In September 1914, the ship finally anchored in Calcutta. The detainees refused to board the train going to Punjab. 22 people were killed in the ensuing clash with the police in Budge Budge, near Calcutta.
- **Enraged Ghadrites:** The Ghadr leaders were enraged by this, and with the onset of the First World War, they resolved to undertake a violent attack to overthrow British control in India. They encouraged fighters to travel to India.

The Ghadar Party and Movement (1915)

The Ghadar movement was a revolutionary attempt by the Ghadar Party to incite an armed uprising against British rule in India. It was triggered by the outbreak of the First World War and the Komagata Maru incident. The planned date for revolt across India was February 21, 1915.

- **Revolutionary roots**: The Ghadar Party, founded in 1913 San Francisco by Lala Hardayal, Sohan Singh Bhakna, Mohammed Barkatullah, and others, became a key revolutionary force during WWI.
- **Secular and widespread**: It was secular in nature and expanded its reach to Indian communities across Asia.
- **Failed insurrection**: The uprising, set to begin in Punjab on February 21, 1915, was foiled by British CID. Many Ghadarites were arrested, tried, and some were executed.
- **British crackdown**: The British responded with sweeping repressive measures—the most severe since 1857—including the Defence of India Act (March 1915), aimed specifically at suppressing the Ghadar movement.

Ghadar's Evaluation

- **Success:**
  - **Ideological success:** The Ghadar movement's success was in the field of ideology.
  - **Promoted nationalism:** It promoted fierce nationalism while being entirely secular.
- **Limitations:**
  - **Underestimated:** The main flaw was that they utterly underestimated the extent and amount of preparation required at every level-organizational, intellectual, financial, and so on--before any violent revolt.
  - **Unorganized:** Another significant issue is the lack of an organisational framework; the Ghadar Movement was sustained more by the militants' zeal than by their ability to organise themselves.
  - **Lack of long-lasting leadership:** The Ghadar Movement also lacked a strong and long-term leadership capable of uniting the movement's diverse parts.
  - **Overlooked:** They overlooked that rallying a few thousand dissatisfied immigrant Indians, who were already emotionally charged due to racial persecution at the hands of white foreigners, was a far cry from mobilising and motivating lakhs of peasants and soldiers in India.

However, it failed to achieve much on the political and military fronts because it lacked organized and sustained leadership, underestimated the extent of preparation required at every level - organizational, ideological, financial, and tactical strategic - and perhaps Lala Hardayal was unsuited for the job of an organizer.

Home Rule Movement

The Home Rule Movement was India's moderate yet impactful response to World War I. Amid wartime hardships like high taxes and rising prices, Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Annie Besant led the campaign with great zeal. The movement aimed to spread the idea of self-government (home rule) among the masses.

Background of the Movement

- **Disappointment of the 1909 Act:** With the disappointment of the 1909 Act and the failure of moderates to make headway, the groundwork has been laid for a new movement.
- **Role of Tilak:** Tilak was released from jail in 1914, ready to take on a larger role; however, Congress' leadership was with moderates, forcing him to form a breakaway organization.
- **Influence of the Russian Revolution:** While the Russian Revolution of 1917 was still in action, it gave an additional edge.
- **Lucknow pact:** In December 1915, the two sides of Congress reconciled. The Congress and the Muslim League formed the historic Lucknow Pact the next year, pledging to work together for representative government in the country.

Home Rule League Movement (September 1916)

- **Resume activities:** Tilak resumed his nationalist activities after his release from prison in 1914. He was attempting to get entry to Congress. His first attempt, however, was foiled by moderates led by Pherozshah Mehta.
- **Opposition decreased:** However, following Pherozshah Mehta's death, opposition against the Extremists decreased and they were allowed to rejoin Congress in December 1915.
- **Attitude of moderates:** There seemed to have been no advance on the front of self-rule, and many leaders were disappointed by the attitude of moderates.
- **Irish influence:** Inspired by the Irish insurrection, Dr Annie Besant (together with George Arundale), who had garnered considerable expertise in national action via her involvement with the Theosophical Society, launched a Home Rule Movement in India in September 1916.
- **Assistance:** B W Wadia and C P Ramaswamy Aiyer assisted her in her attempts.Bal Gangadhar Tilak also launched and enthusiastically supported another Home Rule Movement.
- **Swaraj:** Tilak took the initiative and launched the Maharashtra Home Rule League Movement in April 1916. During the Home Rule Movement, Tilak proclaimed, "Swaraj is my birthright, and I will have it."
- **New political landscape:** Gandhi was not active in the movement since he had only arrived last year and was still navigating the new political landscape.

The Objectives of the Movement

- **To enjoy Dominion status:** 'To enjoy Dominion status, as other British colonies such as Australia, South Africa, and New Zealand do.
- **Promote political education:** To promote political education and debate to generate support for self-government.
- **Motivate Indians:** To motivate Indians to speak out against the government's repression.
- **Pressure on the British government:** To put pressure on the British government to increase Indian political representation.
- **Resurrect political activity:** To resurrect political activity in India while adhering to the principles of the Congress Party.

Reasons Behind the Downfall

- **Moderates were appeased:** After Besant's release, moderates were appeased and the anger subsided.
- **August Declaration1917:** In Britain's Parliament, new Secretary of State Montague claimed that Indians will be granted additional roles in administration (unlike his predecessor Morley, who denied any such possibility). 'August Declaration' was the name given to Montague's proclamation.
- **Rise of Gandhi:** The rise of Gandhi and discussions of civil disobedience diverted national attention.
- **Vacant leadership:** Tilak moved to the United States, leaving a leadership vacant space.
- **Communal riots:** In 1917-18, communal riots erupted.

The Movement's Success

- **Mass support:** The movement was successful in drawing the public, signalling a change away from the elite participation paradigm of moderates.
- **Strengthened Congress:** Tilak and Besant's efforts resurrected Congress following the Lucknow Pact of 1916.
- **Pushed the government:** They pushed the government to pursue more changes in the shape of the Mont-Ford reforms of 1919. Furthermore, the campaign laid the groundwork for Gandhian politics of mass mobilization.
- **Shape the new course:** The Home Rule Leagues and related activities had some good impacts and helped to shape the new course that the liberation movement would take in the coming years.

It established an organizational link between the town and the country, which would be vital later on when the national movement entered its mass phase. It gave the national movement a new dimension and a sense of urgency.

Lucknow Pact (December 1916), its Significance and Impacts

During World War I, Turkey fought against Britain; Muslims supported Turkey and were enraged by the British. Congress was likewise exhausted from pleading for self-government.

A.C. Majumdar (President of the Lucknow session of the INC—1916)
After nearly ten years of painful separation and wandering through the wilderness of misunderstanding and mazes of unpleasant controversies...both wings of the Indian Nationalist Party have come to realize the fact that united they stand, but divided they fall.

Importance of the Lucknow Session

- **Unification:** After a ten-year break after the Surat Split, both Moderates and Extremists were unified in this session.
- **Consensus:** During the Lucknow session, Congress and the Muslim League formed the Lucknow Pact, establishing political consensus on the next steps.
- **Hindu-Muslim cooperation:** It cleared the door for Hindu-Muslim collaboration in the Indian Independence Movement, as evidenced in the Khilafat Movement and the Non-Cooperation Movement.
- **Formalize communal politics:** The agreement between the parties on a distinct communal electorate formally created communal politics in India.
- **Communal veto:** According to the Lucknow Pact of 1916, any legislature would be unable to function if more than 3/4 of members of any faith were opposed to the resolution. Acceptance of such a proposition resulted in the establishment of a type of communal veto in the legislature.
- **Embraced Muslim League:** Through this arrangement, the INC also tacitly embraced the Muslim League's notion that India was divided into two distinct populations with opposing interests.

Evaluation of the Lucknow Session

- **Cooperation in the Khilafat movement:** This contract laid the groundwork for Hindu-Muslim cooperation in the Khilafat movement and Mohandas Gandhi's non-cooperation movement beginning in 1920.
- **Colour of communalism:** The Congress also agreed to separate electorates for Muslims in provincial council elections, which was one of the most contentious aspects of the accord.
- **Blunder by INC:** Acceptance of a separate electorate is seen as one of Congress's worst blunders, leading to potent communalism in the country. Furthermore, neither Hindu nor Muslim masses were involved.
- **Recognised divided interests:** The pact made it evident that India had various communities, each with its own set of interests.
- **Destructive pacifist actions:** The number of Muslim legislators was determined province by province. This was one of Congress's most destructive pacifist actions. It recognised not only communal representation but also communal privileges.

The Congress session at Lucknow had a long-lasting influence on India. It may have temporarily brought the warring groups together, but it legitimized the Muslim League's policies of hatred and division.

Montagu Chelmsford Reforms (1919)

In 1918, the Mont-Ford (Montagu Chelmsford) Commission issued its report. It claimed to prepare the way for Indian self- government, but it also sought to induce Indians to assist the British during the First World War (1914-18). For the first time, the government of India stated its desire to gradually introduce a responsible government.

M. K. Gandhi: *The Montford Reforms... was only a method of further draining India of her wealth and of prolonging her servitude.*

Notable Features

1. Increased Indian Participation & Self-Governance Aim

- The Act aimed to involve more Indians in administration and introduced self-governance as an official goal, as earlier stated in the August Declaration of 1917.
- The number of Indians in the Viceroy's Executive Council was increased to 3 out of 8 (though it remained advisory).
- The demand for self-rule or Home Rule was no longer deemed seditious.

2. Ten-Year Framework & Review

- The reforms were meant to last for ten years (1919–1929).
- A review commission was proposed; this led to the **Simon Commission** (1927), headed by Sir John Simon, to assess progress and suggest further changes.

3. Dyarchy & Decentralization in Provinces

- Introduced **diarchy** in provinces, dividing subjects into:
  - **Reserved Subjects** (defence, foreign affairs, communications) under the Governor and his Executive Council.
  - **Transferred Subjects** (agriculture, health, education, local govt.) managed by Ministers responsible to the Provincial Legislative Council.
- While a step toward decentralization, the system lacked popular support.

4. Legislative Reforms: Bicameralism, Direct Elections & Franchise

- Established a **bicameral legislature** at the Centre: Council of State and Legislative Assembly, with most members **directly elected**.
- Introduced **direct elections** for the first time with limited franchise based on property, tax, or education.
- Created **unicameral Provincial Legislative Councils**.

5. Central Control & Role of Princely States

- Despite provincial reforms, the **Central Legislature** retained the power to legislate for the entire country.
- The **Governor-General** held powers to summon, prorogue, dissolve legislatures, and issue ordinances.
- **Princely States** were included in the Council of State to balance the growing influence of Indian political parties.

Drawbacks of the Reforms

- **Limited franchise:** The franchise was quite restricted. The electorate for the central legislature was increased to around 1.5 million, despite the fact that India's population was estimated to be over 260 million.
- **Veto of viceroy:** The legislature had no authority over the viceroy and his executive council in the centre.
- **Inadequate subject division:** The centre's subject division was inadequate. At the provincial level, subject division and simultaneous administration of two portions were illogical and hence, impractical. Irrigation, finance, police, the press, and justice were all reserved.
- **Less power to provinces:** Provincial ministers had little authority over budgets or bureaucracy, resulting in frequent conflict between the two.
- **Ministers not consulted:** Ministers were frequently not consulted on key subjects as well; in fact, they may be overturned by the governor on any matter deemed exceptional by the latter.

Reception in India

- **Congress disappointment:** The Congress deemed the reforms "disappointing" and "unsatisfactory," instead demanding effective self-government.
- **Unmatched to political demands:** The 1919 changes did not meet India's political demands.
- **Unified in opposition:** The Indian members of the Legislative Council were unified in their opposition to these policies. Several council members, including Jinnah, resigned in protest.
- **Betrayal of masses:** These measures were largely perceived throughout India as a betrayal of the population's strong support for the British war effort.
- **Gandhi's protest:** Gandhi launched a state-wide protest against the Rowlatt Acts, with Punjab leading the way.
- **Massacre:** In April 1919, an unintentional violation of restrictions barring gatherings of people resulted in the killing at Jallianwala Bagh in Amritsar.

The **Montagu-Chelmsford Report** laid the groundwork for the **Government of India Act, 1935**, and eventually influenced the **Indian Constitution**. It introduced key principles such as **responsible government**, **self-governance**, and a **federal structure**. As a landmark in India's constitutional development, the Montagu-Chelmsford Report—along with the **Montagu Declaration**—is often regarded as the **Magna Carta of modern India**.

Contribution of Chandrasekhar Azad

Chandrasekhar Azad was a pivotal figure in the Indian freedom struggle, known for his commitment to absolute independence and his readiness to employ armed resistance against British colonial rule. Born on July 23, 1906, in Bhabhra, Madhya Pradesh, Azad became a symbol of bravery and self-sacrifice in the annals of Indian history.

Early Life and Influences

- **Early Radicalization:** Azad was deeply affected by the Jallianwala Bagh massacre in 1919, which precipitated his strong resolve against British rule. His early involvement with the Non-Cooperation Movement initiated by Mahatma Gandhi also shaped his path, but he was disillusioned by the suspension of the movement following the Chauri Chaura incident in 1922.
- **Turn Towards Revolutionary Activities:** This disillusionment led him to the Hindustan Republican Association (HRA,1924), which later became the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA), where he was significantly influenced by figures like Ram Prasad Bismil.

Major Contributions

1. Transformation of HRA into HSRA

- In 1928, Azad and Bhagat Singh restructured the **Hindustan Republican Association (HRA)** into the **Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)** to pursue **complete independence** through **organized, revolutionary violence** and to establish a **socialist India**.

2. Role in Key Revolutionary Actions

- **Kakori Train Robbery (1925):** Though not directly involved, Azad helped in its planning and managed the aftermath, aiding in securing funds for the cause.

- **Saunders' Assassination (1928):** Avenging Lala Lajpat Rai's death, Azad conspired with others to kill British officer **J.P. Saunders**.
- **Central Assembly Bombing (1929):** While Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt executed the act, Azad played a key role in its planning.

3. Spreading Revolutionary & Socialist Ideals

- Azad actively **recruited youth**, promoted **socialist thought**, and turned **Jhansi into a training centre** for revolutionaries, energizing the freedom struggle with ideology and action.

Strategy and Ideology

- **Guerrilla Warfare:** Azad advocated and practiced guerrilla tactics, which involved sudden attacks on British officials and thefts that funded their activities. His methods were marked by a bold and uncompromising stance against the British, differentiating him from more moderate approaches of the time.
- **Vision for Post-Independence India:** Although primarily focused on the overthrow of British rule, Azad and his comrades had a vision of a socialist India where justice and social equity prevailed. They believed in the destruction of the current system and its replacement with a socialist struct.

Legacy and Death

- **Icon of Bravery and Sacrifice:** Azad's commitment to never being captured alive by the British was fulfilled when he shot himself on February 27, 1931, during a face-off with the police in Alfred Park, Allahabad. He became a martyr and an enduring symbol of resistance against oppression.
- **Inspirational Figure:** His legacy inspires countless Indians, and many public institutions and movements have been named in his honor to commemorate his sacrifice for Indian independence.

Chandrasekhar Azad remains one of the most celebrated revolutionaries in Indian history. His life is a testament to the lengths to which passionate individuals will go to fight for their country's freedom. His tactics, ideological commitment to socialism, and the ultimate sacrifice continue to be revered and studied as a major part of India's struggle for independence.

Kakori Conspiracy Case Events

On 9 August 1925, the Number 8 Down Train was travelling from Shahjahanpur to Lucknow. As the train passed the village of Kakori, one of the revolutionaries, Rajendra Lahiri, pulled the emergency chain, bringing the train to a halt. The other revolutionaries quickly overpowered the guard, making their way to the guards' cabin. Their target was the money bags, which contained around ₹8,000—a substantial amount collected from taxes levied on Indians. After securing the money, they escaped towards Lucknow.

Kakori Conspiracy Case Trial

- Following the Kakori train robbery, the British government launched an extensive investigation. Within a month, most of the conspirators were arrested. Leaders like Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Rajendra Lahiri, Sachindranath Sanyal, Sachindranath Bakshi, Govind Charan Kar, Jogesh Chandra Chatterjee, Thakur Roshan Singh were arrested. Prominent leader Chandrashekhar Azad managed to evade capture.
- In the trial, which took place between 1925 and 1926, the British charged the accused with robbery and murder under stringent laws of sedition.
- Despite a strong defence, four revolutionaries were sentenced to death: Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Rajendra Lahiri, and Thakur Roshan Singh.
- Several others like Sachindranath Sanyal, and Sachindranath Bakshi were deported to Kala Pani. Many were sentenced to life imprisonment or long terms in prison.

Kakori Conspiracy Case Impact

- The Kakori Conspiracy Case had a profound impact on the Indian freedom movement. The execution of key leaders like Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, and Rajendra Lahiri made them martyrs. It also inspired future revolutionaries, such as Bhagat Singh and Chandrashekhar Azad, to continue the fight against British rule.
- In the aftermath of the Kakori incident, the Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) realized the need to refine its ideology and tactics.
- In 1928, the organization rebranded itself as the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA).
- The Kakori Conspiracy thus energized the revolutionary movement and contributed to shaping the ideological framework of future revolutionary groups.

Key Words

Lord Curzon, Partition of Bengal, Reactionary policies, Swadeshi movement, Nationalist response, Curzon's reforms, Communal divide, Political instability, Anti-colonial movement, Revolutionary activities.

	Previous Year Questions	Year
1.	Evaluate the policies of Lord Curzon and their long-term implications on the national movements.	2020